

To whom it may concern,

It is our pleasure to write this letter of recommendation on behalf of Gorka Crespo Bravo, whom we had the privilege of supervising during his Banking and Quantitative Finance Master's thesis at the University of the Basque Country (UPV/EHU).

We first met Gorka as a student in our Master's courses in Stochastic Processes and Financial Econometrics, where his enthusiasm for finance was already clear. We later worked with him more closely as supervisors of his Master's Thesis, which examined tail-risk connectedness in the European financial system and its implications for portfolio construction. That same enthusiasm never wavered throughout the two years of the Master's program, and came through clearly in the dedication and drive he brought to his research. The work required Gorka to combine rigorous quantitative analysis with a strong grasp of financial markets, using Python and R to work with real market data from Refinitiv. His findings showed that incorporating tail-dependence measures into portfolio construction improved standard risk-adjusted performance indicators, including the Sharpe ratio and expected shortfall, relative to conventional approaches. Beyond the technical execution, Gorka showed genuine research maturity by proposing original methodological extensions and identifying promising avenues for further research. The quality of his work is, in our view, of publishable standard, which speaks to the rigor and depth Gorka brings to his analytical work.

Throughout this process, Gorka showed himself to be an exceptionally diligent and results-oriented individual, taking full ownership of his work and remaining composed under pressure, consistently identifying practical solutions and adapting efficiently to shifting priorities without compromising quality. He also exhibited a genuine entrepreneurial spirit, often proposing new approaches rather than simply following established methods, all while maintaining a professional and approachable manner that contributed to a collaborative working environment. This collaborative nature was also reflected in his generosity in sharing both his own work, through public repositories, and his knowledge with others. Gorka has consistently responded to feedback in a constructive manner, using it not only to improve his work but to reinforce and strengthen his own proposals. He is approachable and easy to engage with in person, while also working with a strong sense of autonomy, staying consistently on track with his responsibilities without needing close guidance. His strong critical thinking and communication skills were evident throughout, allowing him to integrate quickly into demanding, collaborative settings.

In light of the above, we recommend Gorka without reservation for the position at your organization. We are confident that his analytical rigor and professional discipline will make him a valuable addition to your team.

Should you require any further information, we remain at your disposal.

Sincerely,

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